SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

5 July 2022 · Shift 1

69 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 31 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. One's cup of tea

(A) One's perception about someone
(B) One's general principle
(C) One's hard-earned money
(D) One's chosen or preferred thing

Q.2

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the bracketed word in the given sentence. It is irrelevance, at least to me, whether the grant was (improvident) or no.

(A) tardy
(B) thrifty
(C) cautious
(D) hungry

Q.3

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. When you are under significant stress, it is hardly to process details and nuances.

(A) significant stress, it is hardly
(B) to process details and nuances
(C) When you are under
(D) No error

Q.4

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The reduced air pressure on airline flights can lessen the amount of oxygen in passengers' blood for twenty-five percent.

(A) The reduced air pressure on airline flights
(B) No error
(C) in passengers' blood for twenty-five percent
(D) can lessen the amount of oxygen

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. My teacher asked me to keep _____.

(A) quiet
(B) quite
(C) quit
(D) quaint

Q.6

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Perilous

(A) Verbose
(B) Unstable
(C) cruel
(D) Safe

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. He claims to be the _____ kid in the school.

(A) smartness
(B) smartest
(C) smarting
(D) smarter

Q.8

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Many families are “so poor” to bear the cost of educating all their children.

(A) No improvement required
(B) too poor
(C) to poor
(D) such poor

Q.9

Select the option that corrects the misspelt words in the given sentence. Surely, he now has earned the repsect ‘mastr’.

(A) Surly, he now has earned the respect ‘muster’.
(B) Surly, he now has earned the repsect ‘masterr’.
(C) Surely, he now has earned the repsect ‘masteer’.
(D) Surely, he now has earned the respect ‘master’.

Q.10

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A book that contains information on various subjects

(A) Encyclopaedia
(B) Manuscript
(C) Thesaurus
(D) Dictionary

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. The more “enlightened” employers offer better terms.

(A) Civilised
(B) Educated
(C) Confounded
(D) Reasonable

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Hasty

(A) Expeditious
(B) Restricted
(C) Laidback
(D) Locked

Q.13

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The water at her place “was cool and had” a metallic taste.

(A) was cooling and have
(B) No improvement required
(C) were cool and have
(D) was coolest and has

Q.14

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Perterb
(B) Perceive
(C) Pigeon
(D) Passive

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Chew the scenery

(A) To understate
(B) To act overly emotional
(C) To beautify
(D) To mismanage

Q.16

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Banning food and beverages is “not” desirable nor feasible in a civilized society.

(A) neither
(B) No improvement required
(C) none
(D) nor

Q.17

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Scientists believe / that many animals have / a unique languages / of their own.

(A) that many animals have
(B) Scientists believe
(C) a unique languages
(D) of their own

Q.18

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. The plan is to “demolish” the kitchen area and build a new room.

(A) curtail
(B) forge
(C) raze
(D) refurbish

Q.19

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A thing or substance that is liable to catch fire easily

(A) Inaudible
(B) Inflammable
(C) Incombustible
(D) Extinguishable

Q.20

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A group of guns or missile launchers operated together at one place

(A) Psaltery
(B) Skittery
(C) Cemetery
(D) Battery

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Deforestation in tropical regions can (1) _____ the way water vapour is produced over the canopy, (2) _____ causes reduced rainfall. A 2019 study published in the journal Ecohydrology showed that parts of the Amazon rainforest that (3) _____ converted to agricultural land (4) _____ higher soil and air temperatures, which could (5) _____ drought conditions.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) hold
(B) attack
(C) affect
(D) effect

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Deforestation in tropical regions can (1) _____ the way water vapour is produced over the canopy, (2) _____ causes reduced rainfall. A 2019 study published in the journal Ecohydrology showed that parts of the Amazon rainforest that (3) _____ converted to agricultural land (4) _____ higher soil and air temperatures, which could (5) _____ drought conditions.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) whom
(B) which
(C) where
(D) who

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Deforestation in tropical regions can (1) _____ the way water vapour is produced over the canopy, (2) _____ causes reduced rainfall. A 2019 study published in the journal Ecohydrology showed that parts of the Amazon rainforest that (3) _____ converted to agricultural land (4) _____ higher soil and air temperatures, which could (5) _____ drought conditions.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) is
(B) were
(C) was
(D) has

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Deforestation in tropical regions can (1) _____ the way water vapour is produced over the canopy, (2) _____ causes reduced rainfall. A 2019 study published in the journal Ecohydrology showed that parts of the Amazon rainforest that (3) _____ converted to agricultural land (4) _____ higher soil and air temperatures, which could (5) _____ drought conditions.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) had
(B) did
(C) was
(D) has

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Deforestation in tropical regions can (1) _____ the way water vapour is produced over the canopy, (2) _____ causes reduced rainfall. A 2019 study published in the journal Ecohydrology showed that parts of the Amazon rainforest that (3) _____ converted to agricultural land (4) _____ higher soil and air temperatures, which could (5) _____ drought conditions.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) purify
(B) inflame
(C) provoke
(D) aggravate

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. Some X are M. II. All W are X. Conclusions: I. Some M are not W. II. No W is M. III. Some M are not X.

(A) None of the conclusions follow
(B) Only conclusion III follows
(C) Only conclusions II and III follow
(D) All the conclusions follow

Q.2

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All sweets are food. All food are healthy. Conclusions: I) All sweets are healthy. I)I Some healthy are sweets.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.3

In a certain code language, 'RESTRICT' is written as 'CTRISTRE', 'STARTING' is written as 'NGTIARST' and 'MOUNTAIN' is written as 'INTAUNMO'. What is the code for the word 'ENVELOPE' in that code language?

(A) ELOOEENP
(B) PELOVEEN
(C) PEELOVEN
(D) EPOLEVNE

Q.5

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. I4D : G9F :: L16S : J25U :: W64R : ?

(A) T81U
(B) U81T
(C) U49T
(D) S49T

Q.8

Select the option that is related to the sixth number in the same way as the first number is related to the second number and the third number is related to the fourth number. 144 : 225 :: 169 : 256 :: ? : 361

(A) 196
(B) 324
(C) 256
(D) 144

Q.9

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. PG : VM :: AB : ?

(A) FH
(B) GH
(C) HI
(D) FG

Q.10

In a certain code language, 'FAINT' is coded as '2014916', and 'GRME' is coded as '513187'. How will 'POIL' be coded in that language?

(A) 1295116
(B) 1291516
(C) 1219516
(D) 1291561

Q.11

By interchanging the given two numbers (not digits), which of the following equations will be correct? 44 and 19; I. 203 + 44 – 27 × 19 ÷ 11 = 114; II. 9 × 572 ÷ 19 – 44 + 4 = 120

(A) Neither I nor II
(B) Only I
(C) Only II
(D) Both I and II

Q.12

Four males P1, P2, P3 and P4 are sitting in a row facing towards the North (not necessarily in the same order) and four females A1, A2, A3 and A4 are sitting in a row facing towards the face of these males (not necessarily in the same order). P1 and P4 sit at the ends. A3 and P2 are facing each other. A4 is second to the left of A3. P4 is facing A1. A1 and A4 are at the ends. Which of the following statements is correct? I. A4 is facing P1. II. P4 is second to the left of that male who is facing A2.

(A) Only II
(B) Neither I nor II
(C) Only I
(D) Both I and II

Q.14

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. GF, KI, OL, SO, ?

(A) YS
(B) WR
(C) WS
(D) XR

Q.15

Five people, P, Q, R, S, and T, are sitting in a straight row, facing north. Q sits to the immediate left of S. Only three people sit between R and T. P sits to the immediate left of T. Who sits in the middle of the row?

(A) T
(B) P
(C) Q
(D) S

Q.17

Select the option in which the pair of letter-clusters share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of letter-clusters. TRACK : IAYPR :: ?

(A) PROUD : NPMSB
(B) STRAW : UYPRQ
(C) POLDY : WBJQN
(D) GAMES : UGOCE

Q.18

Seven athletes A, B, C, D, E, F and G participate in a race. E is ahead of A but behind F. D is ahead of only two athlete. G is running last. C is running behind only two athlete. F is not the first. Which athlete is running in the fourth position from behind?

(A) C
(B) E
(C) A
(D) D

Q.19

In a certain code language, 'ACD' is coded as '12', and 'BEA' is coded as '10'. How will 'ECG' be coded in that language?

(A) 105
(B) 85
(C) 115
(D) 125

Q.20

In a certain code language, 'COBBLESTONES' is written as 'BBOCTSELSENO', and 'SATISFACTORY' is written as 'ITASCAFSYROT'. How will 'TACHYCARDIAS' be written in that code language?

(A) HACTRACYSAID
(B) HCATRACYSAID
(C) HCATCARSAIDY
(D) YHCATCARSAID

Q.22

Select the numbers from among the given options that can replace the question marks (?) in the following series. 8, 9, 5, 16, 27, 25, 32, 81, 125, ?, 243, ?

(A) 325, 64
(B) 375, 64
(C) 64, 375
(D) 64, 625

Q.23

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the given sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g.13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) (12, 8, 16); (22, 10, 144)

(A) (28, 20, 36)
(B) (16, 10, 24)
(C) (24, 12, 121)
(D) (18, 8, 100)

Q.24

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 17, 25, 34, 44, 55, ?

(A) 68
(B) 67
(C) 69
(D) 66

Q.25

After interchanging the given two numbers, what will be the value of the given expression? 20 and 10; 10 + 30 – 5 × 20 ÷ 2

(A) 20
(B) 30
(C) 25
(D) 35

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Which of the following states of India will host the 2023 Men's Hockey World Cup?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Odisha
(C) Karnataka
(D) Uttar Pradesh

Q.2

Who among the following personalities, known by the affectionate moniker ‘Nightingale of India’, passed away in February 2022?

(A) Lata Mangeshkar
(B) Saroj Khan
(C) Abhilasha Patil
(D) Tarla Joshi

Q.3

Shiv Kumar Sharma is associated with which instrument?

(A) Sitar
(B) Santoor
(C) Nadaswaram
(D) Dholak

Q.4

In which state of India is Konark dance festival celebrated?

(A) Karnataka
(B) Odisha
(C) Jharkhand
(D) Rajasthan

Q.5

Which of the following states has two houses in its state legislature?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Maharashtra
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Jharkhand

Q.6

Which of the following is the only large river in the Indian desert?

(A) Kosi River
(B) Betwa River
(C) Luni River
(D) Banas River

Q.7

Which country won the 2018 FIH Men’s Hockey World Cup?

(A) Belgium
(B) Australia
(C) The Netherlands
(D) Spain

Q.8

Who is the author of the book ‘Modi Government: New Surge of Communalism’?

(A) Pranab Mukherjee
(B) Jaswant Singh
(C) Sitaram Yechury
(D) M J Akbar

Q.9
Aihole was the capital of the _____.

(A) Chalukyas
(B) Pallavas
(C) Pandayas
(D) Cholas

Q.10
Who among the following devised the policy 'Doctrine of Lapse'?

(A) Lord Dalhousie
(B) Lord Mountbatten
(C) Lord Cornwallis
(D) Lord Canning

Q.11
Tankeswar Hazarika Borbayan received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for the year 2018 for his contribution to which classical dance of India?

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Bharatanatyam
(C) Sattriya
(D) Kathak

Q.12
Which Department of the Government of India launched 'One Health' pilot project in April 2022?

(A) Department of Consumer Affairs
(B) Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying
(C) Department of Pharmaceuticals
(D) Department of Commerce

Q.13
Which of the following is an example of artificial ecosystem?

(A) Garden
(B) Forest
(C) Lake
(D) Pond

Q.14
Which of the following substances is insoluble in water?

(A) Salt
(B) Sugar
(C) Chalk powder
(D) Milk

Q.15
How many fundamental duties of Indian citizens are there in the Indian Constitution, as of March 2022?

(A) 5
(B) 11
(C) 9
(D) 3

Q.16
At which Buddhist site of India did Gautama Buddha first preach the Dharma?

(A) Kushinagar
(B) Barabar Caves
(C) Bodh Gaya
(D) Sarnath

Q.17
The Treaty of Lahore was signed in 1846 between the British empire and _____.

(A) Maharaja Kharak Singh
(B) Maharani Chand Kaur
(C) Maharaja Ranjit Singh
(D) Maharaja Duleep Singh

Q.18
Antyodaya Anna Yozana (AAY) was launched by the government to fight _____.

(A) unemployment
(B) poverty
(C) environmental degradation
(D) population growth

Q.19

What is the sex ratio (Approx) of India as per Census 2011?

(A) 940 females per 1000 males
(B) 740 females per 1000 males
(C) 640 females per 1000 males
(D) 840 females per 1000 males

Q.20

Sam talks about an example of an igneous rock. Which of the following can it be?

(A) Sandstone
(B) Basalt
(C) Limestone
(D) Marble

Q.21

The financial year in the Indian economy runs from _____.

(A) 1 January to 31 May
(B) 1 April to 30 June
(C) 1 June to 31 March
(D) 1 April to 31 March

Q.22

Which of the following is the state of origin of the Odissi dance form?

(A) Andhra Pradesh
(B) Odisha
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Kerala

Q.23

Which of the following trains of India is the fastest (as per trial runs), as of April 2022?

(A) Vande Bharat Express (Train 18)
(B) Maharashtra Sampark Kranti Express
(C) Howrah Rajdhani Express
(D) Howrah Ranchi Shatabdi Express

Q.24

Ghiyasuddin Balban (1265-1286 AD), ruler of the Slave dynasty, took up the title of _____.

(A) Nur-al-Din (light of the faith)
(B) NurMahal (light of the palace)
(C) Zil-i-Ilahi (shadow of God)
(D) JahanPanah (protector of the world)

Q.25

What is the chemical formula of baking soda?

(A) $NaHCO_3$
(B) NH_4Cl
(C) Na_2CO_3
(D) $CaSO_4$

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(B)**
Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**
Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (D) One's chosen or preferred thing

'One's cup of tea' is something one likes or prefers.

Q.2 · Answer (B) thrifty

'Improvident' means not providing for the future, wasteful with money; its opposite is 'thrifty', careful with money.

Q.3 · Answer (A) significant stress, it is hardly

'It is' needs the adjective 'hard' (difficult): 'it is hard to process details and nuances'. 'Hardly' is an adverb meaning scarcely.

Q.4 · Answer (C) in passengers' blood for twenty-five percent

A change by an amount takes 'by': 'lessen the amount of oxygen in passengers' blood by twenty-five percent'.

Q.5 · Answer (A) quiet

To 'keep quiet' is to stay silent. 'Quite' means fairly, 'quit' means stop and 'quaint' means charmingly old-fashioned.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Safe

'Perilous' means full of danger; its opposite is 'safe'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) smartest

'The ... in the school' compares him with everyone in the school, so the superlative 'smartest' is needed.

Q.8 · Answer (B) too poor

'Too' with an adjective and 'to' says something is beyond a limit: 'too poor to bear the cost'. 'So poor' would need 'that they cannot bear'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Surely, he now has earned the respect ‘master’.

'Repsect' should be 'respect' and 'mastr' 'master'. 'Surely' is already right, so the options with 'Surly' (bad-tempered) spoil it.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Encyclopaedia

An encyclopaedia holds information on many subjects. A thesaurus lists words of similar meaning, a dictionary explains words and a manuscript is a handwritten or unpublished text.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Confounded

'Enlightened' means well-informed and rational; 'confounded', confused and perplexed, is the nearest opposite. 'Civilised', 'educated' and 'reasonable' are close to it in meaning.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Expeditious

'Hasty' means done in a hurry; 'expeditious', done quickly, is the only option close to it in meaning. 'Laidback' (relaxed) is nearly the opposite, and 'restricted' and 'locked' are unrelated.

Q.13 · Answer (B) No improvement required

The sentence is already correct: the uncountable 'water' takes the singular 'was', and the past 'had' matches it.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Perterb

'Perterb' is misspelt: the word is 'perturb', to disturb or worry.

Q.15 · Answer (B) To act overly emotional

An actor 'chews the scenery' when he overacts, playing a part with too much emotion.

Q.16 · Answer (A) neither

'Nor' pairs with 'neither': 'neither desirable nor feasible'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) a unique languages
The article 'a' goes with a singular noun: 'a unique language of their own'.

Q.18 · Answer (C) raze
To 'demolish' a building is to pull it down; to 'raze' is to destroy it completely. 'Refurbish' means renovate and 'curtail' cut short.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Inflammable
'Inflammable', like 'flammable', means easily set on fire; 'incombustible' means the opposite.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Battery
A battery is a group of guns or missile launchers operated together at one place. A psaltery is an ancient stringed instrument and a cemetery a burial ground.

Q.21 · Answer (C) affect
The verb 'affect' means to influence: deforestation can affect the way water vapour is produced. 'Effect' is usually a noun, and as a verb means to bring about.

Q.22 · Answer (B) which
'Which' begins a clause about the change just described, a thing, not a person or place: 'which causes reduced rainfall'.

Q.23 · Answer (B) were
The subject 'parts' is plural and the study looks back on what happened, so the past passive is 'were converted'.

Q.24 · Answer (A) had
The study 'showed' what those parts 'had': the past tense keeps the report consistent.

Q.25 · Answer (D) aggravate
Higher temperatures could 'aggravate', that is worsen, drought conditions. 'Inflame' and 'provoke' are used of feelings or conflict.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (A) None of the conclusions follow
Some X are M and all W are X, but nothing links W to M: every M could be a W, or none could, so neither I nor II is certain. Every M could also be an X, so III does not follow either.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Both conclusions I and II follow
All sweets are food and all food is healthy, so all sweets are healthy (I), and so some healthy things are sweets (II, printed 'I)I').

Q.3 · Answer (B) PELOVEEN
The word is split into pairs and the pairs are written in reverse order: RE ST RI CT → CT RI ST RE. So EN VE LO PE → PE LO VE EN: PELOVEEN.

Q.5 · Answer (B) U81T
The first letter moves back 2, the number goes from one square to the next and the last letter moves on 2: I → G, $2^2 \rightarrow 3^2$, D → F and L → J, $4^2 \rightarrow 5^2$, S → U. So W → U, $8^2 \rightarrow 9^2 = 81$, R → T: U81T.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 256
Each pair is the squares of two numbers 3 apart: $12^2 : 15^2$ and $13^2 : 16^2$. So ? : 19^2 gives $16^2 = 256$.

Q.9 · Answer (B) GH
Each letter moves 6 places on: P → V and G → M. So A → G and B → H: GH.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 1291516
The word is reversed and each letter written as its place in the alphabet: FAINT → T N I A F → 20 14 9 1 6 and GRME → E M R G → 5 13 18 7. So POIL → L I O P → 12 9 15 16: 1291516.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Only I

With 44 and 19 swapped, I becomes 203 + 19 – 27 × 44 ÷ 11 = 203 + 19 – 108 = 114, which is true, and II becomes 9 × 572 ÷ 44 – 19 + 4 = 117 – 19 + 4 = 102, not 120.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Both I and II

Number the places 1 to 4 from the males' left; the females face them, so a female's left is the males' right. A1 and A4 are at the ends and A4 is second to the left of A3, so A3 is at 2, A4 at 4 and A1 at 1. P4 faces A1, so P4 is at 1, P1 at 4, P2 (facing A3) at 2, and P3 and A2 at 3. A4 faces P1 (I), and P4 is second to the left of P3, who faces A2 (II).

Q.14 · Answer (B) WR

The first letters move on 4 (G, K, O, S, W) and the second on 3 (F, I, L, O, R): WR.

Q.15 · Answer (D) S

With three people between them, R and T sit at the ends. P is immediately left of T, so T is at the right end and R at the left, and Q, S take the second and third places: R Q S P T. S is in the middle.

Q.17 · Answer (B) STRAW : UYPRQ

TRACK is reversed (KCART) and each letter moved back 2: IAYPR. Likewise STRAW → WARTS → UYPRQ.

Q.18 · Answer (B) E

D has two athletes behind it, so it is 5th; G is 7th, and C, with two ahead of it, is 3rd. That leaves places 1, 2, 4 and 6 for A, B, E and F, with F ahead of E and E ahead of A; F is not first, so B is 1st, F 2nd, E 4th and A 6th. Fourth from behind is 4th place: E.

Q.19 · Answer (A) 105

The code is the product of the letters' places in the alphabet: ACD → 1 × 3 × 4 = 12 and BEA → 2 × 5 × 1 = 10. So ECG → 5 × 3 × 7 = 105.

Q.20 · Answer (B) HCATRACYSAID

The word is split into groups of four and each group reversed: COBB LEST ONES → BBOC TSEL SENO. So TACH YCAR DIAS → HCAT RACY SAID: HCATRACYSAID.

Q.22 · Answer (D) 64, 625

Three series are interleaved: 8, 16, 32, 64 (×2); 9, 27, 81, 243 (×3); 5, 25, 125, 625 (×5). The missing terms are 64 and 625.

Q.23 · Answer (D) (18, 8, 100)

The third number is the square of the difference of the first two: $(12 – 8)^2 = 16$ and $(22 – 10)^2 = 144$. Likewise $(18 – 8)^2 = 100$; the other options would need 64, 36 and 144.

Q.24 · Answer (B) 67

The differences are 8, 9, 10, 11, so the next is 12: 55 + 12 = 67.

Q.25 · Answer (C) 25

With 20 and 10 swapped: 20 + 30 – 5 × 10 ÷ 2 = 20 + 30 – 25 = 25.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Odisha

The 2023 Men's Hockey World Cup was held in Odisha, at Bhubaneswar and Rourkela, in January 2023; Bhubaneswar had also hosted the 2018 edition.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Lata Mangeshkar

Lata Mangeshkar, the playback singer widely called the Nightingale of India, died in Mumbai on 6 February 2022. (The same title is given to Sarojini Naidu.)

Q.3 · Answer (B) Santoor

Pandit Shivkumar Sharma made the santoor, a hammered dulcimer from Jammu and Kashmir, a concert instrument of Hindustani classical music.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Odisha
The Konark Dance Festival is held in Odisha every December, beside the Sun Temple at Konark, with performances of India's classical dances.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Maharashtra
Maharashtra has a bicameral legislature, a Legislative Council as well as a Legislative Assembly; Gujarat, Rajasthan and Jharkhand had only an assembly when the exam was held (July 2022).

Q.6 · Answer (C) Luni River
The Luni rises in the Aravallis near Ajmer and flows south-west to the Rann of Kachchh; it is the only large river of the Thar Desert.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Belgium
Belgium won the 2018 Men's Hockey World Cup at Bhubaneswar, beating the Netherlands on a shoot-out in the final.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Sitaram Yechury
'Modi Government: New Surge of Communalism' is a collection of the CPI(M) leader Sitaram Yechury's writings on communalism.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Chalukyas
Aihole, in Karnataka's Bagalkot district, was an early capital of the Chalukyas of Badami; its many early temples have earned it the name 'cradle of Indian temple architecture'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Lord Dalhousie
Lord Dalhousie, Governor-General from 1848 to 1856, used the Doctrine of Lapse to annex states whose ruler died without a natural heir, such as Satara, Jhansi and Nagpur.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Sattriya
Tankeswar Hazarika Borbayan received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for 2018 for Sattriya, the classical dance that grew in Assam's Vaishnava monasteries (sattras).

Q.12 · Answer (B) Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying
The Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying launched a 'One Health' pilot in Uttarakhand in April 2022, to deal with human, animal and environmental health together.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Garden
A garden is made and kept up by people, so it is an artificial (man-made) ecosystem; forests, lakes and ponds are natural ones.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Chalk powder
Chalk is calcium carbonate, which does not dissolve in water and settles out; salt and sugar dissolve, and milk mixes evenly with water.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 11
In March 2022 Article 51A listed 11 fundamental duties: ten added by the 42nd Amendment in 1976 and the eleventh, on giving children aged 6 to 14 the chance of education, by the 86th Amendment in 2002.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Sarnath
The Buddha gave his first sermon, the Dharmachakra Pravartana, in the Deer Park at Sarnath near Varanasi. He attained enlightenment at Bodh Gaya and died at Kushinagar.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Maharaja Duleep Singh
The Treaty of Lahore (March 1846) ended the First Anglo-Sikh War; the Sikh state was then ruled by the boy Maharaja Duleep Singh, with his mother Jind Kaur as regent.

Q.18 · Answer (B) poverty
Antyodaya Anna Yojana, launched in December 2000, entitles the poorest families to 35 kg of food grain a month at highly subsidised prices (free since January 2023), against poverty and hunger.

Q.19 · Answer (A) 940 females per 1000 males
Census 2011 counted 940 females per 1,000 males in its provisional figures (943 in the final data); the other options are far lower.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Basalt
Basalt forms when lava cools at the surface, so it is igneous. Sandstone and limestone are sedimentary rocks and marble is metamorphic.

Q.21 · Answer (D) 1 April to 31 March
India's financial year runs from 1 April to 31 March, the period the Union Budget covers.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Odisha
Odissi, one of India's classical dances, comes from Odisha, where it grew in the temple tradition.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Vande Bharat Express (Train 18)
In a trial run on the Kota-Sawai Madhopur section in December 2018, Train 18, later named the Vande Bharat Express, crossed 180 km/h, well above the top speeds of the other three trains.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Zil-i-Ilahi (shadow of God)
Balban took the title Zil-i-Ilahi, the shadow of God, to raise the Sultan's standing, and brought in the court customs of sijda (prostration) and paibos (kissing the Sultan's feet).

Q.25 · Answer (A) $NaHCO_3$
Baking soda is sodium hydrogen carbonate (sodium bicarbonate), $NaHCO_3$. Na_2CO_3 is sodium carbonate (washing soda as its hydrate), NH_4Cl ammonium chloride and $CaSO_4$ calcium sulphate.

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